

A changing land

War's end brought the passage of the Thirteenth Amendment, ending slavery forever. As a backlash in the South unfolded, Douglass began to focus on Black rights. During the 1868 presidential contest, he campaigned for Ulysses S. Grant, who was the Republican candidate. With Grant in office, Congress passed the Fifteenth Amendment guaranteeing all men the right to vote, regardless of race. In 1870, Douglass and his family moved to Washington, D.C., where he continued to lecture and write. The Equal Rights Party nominated him for vice president in the 1872 election but he declined. In 1889, he became U.S. minister resident to Haiti, and died of a heart attack six years later.